



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's go to Basque country!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- How would you define culture?
- Do you think Colombia is a country of great culture?
- How is Colombian culture passed on to younger generations?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about different cultures, civilizations, and social issues.
- I can speculate about actions and events.
- I can report facts about events or actions.

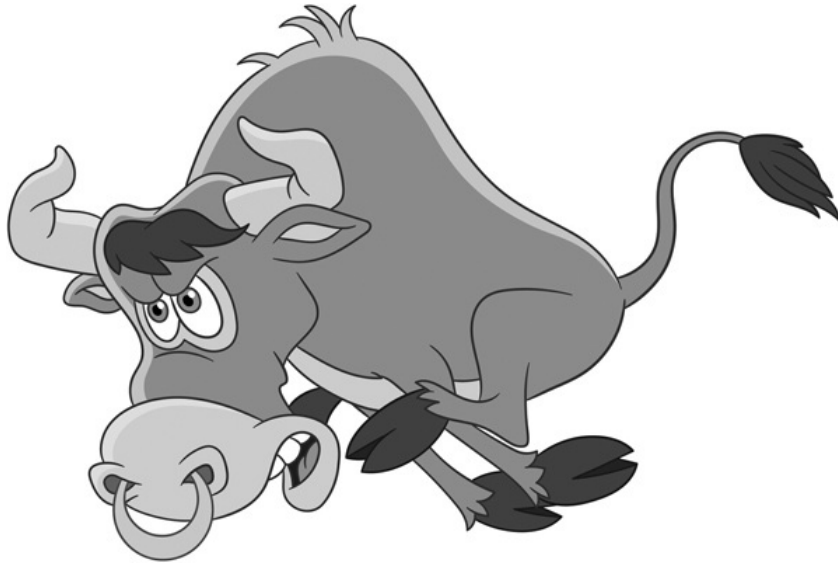




Let's Explore!

The countryside is dotted with **picturesque*** villages and cities.

* "Picturesque" means attractive, especially in a quaint old-fashioned way.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Euskal Herria is believed to be home to more than 3 million Basque people. It is said to translate as "land of the Basque language."

The early Basques decided on settling the area thousands of years ago. Through the centuries, they got used to facing Roman, Arab, French, and, most recently, Spanish conquerors. They have always survived and kept on holding out as a separate cultural group. In 1980, they officially become the Basque Autonomous Community.

This region, is known to consist of miles of green hills and thick forests. It is reported to be dotted with picturesque villages and cities. While about half of the Basque people are said to still dwell in villages, earning their living through more traditional means such as farming and fishing, many have become more interested in doing more lucrative industrial jobs and many others have decided on joining the fast growing high-tech sector.

No matter where they live, the Basque national spirit is apparent and reflected in many aspects of society. It's seen in their language, which is considered to be the tie that binds all Basques. It's in their festivals, such as the world-famous Festival of San Fermin, known for having the running of the bulls through the streets of Pamplona.

The Basques are fiercely proud and will not stand for losing any of their national identity or ancient heritage. As an old Basque was said to proclaim, "Before God was God and boulders were boulders, the Basques were already devoted to being Basques."





Let's Practice!

Basque people are believed to have little connection to other European cultures.

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

dwelt / binds / disconnected / located / dotted

1. Basque language is believed to be totally _____ to the rest of the European languages.
2. The Basque country is believed to be _____ only in Spain, but it has a small territory in France as well.
3. The Basque country is reported to be _____ with picturesque villages and cities that attract a lot of tourists.
4. Half of the Basque people are reported to _____ in villages.
5. The Basque language is considered to be the tie of _____ people in the Basque country.



Let's Practice!

Basques have kept on living as a separate cultural group.

Instructions: Write the sentences in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. used to / the centuries, / facing conquerors. / Through / Basques got

2. on holding / group. / out as / Basques / have kept/ a separate

3. in doing / have become / industrial jobs. / more lucrative / Young Basques / more interested

4. Many Basques / the high-tech / have decided / sector. / to join

5. for having / streets. / The festival / is known/ bulls running / in the / in San Fermin /or having





Extension Activity

Write a tourism brochure for Basque country.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library to find out about Basque country.
- Who are the people, where do they live, what do they eat and drink?
- Find out about their music and art and cultural events.
- Take notes and use the material to a one page tourism brochure about Basque country.
- Divide the brochure into topic sections and write 5 sentences about each.
- Bring your brochure to class and share it with other students.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I go online or to the library to find out about Basque country.

☐ ☐

I take notes on about the people, food, drink, music, art and culture.

☐ ☐

I use my notes to put together a tourism brochure broken into sections.

☐ ☐

I share my brochure with other students.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to settle** (verb): to tame the land to live on
e.g. The early Basques decided on settling the area thousands of years ago.
- conqueror** (noun): people who take over another country
e.g. They got used to facing Roman, Arab, French, and, most recently, Spanish conquerors.
- to hold out** (verb): to continue to defend against
e.g. They have always survived and kept on holding out as a separate cultural group.
- autonomous** (adjective): independent
e.g. In 1980, they officially become the Basque Autonomous Community.
- to consist** (verb): to be made up of
e.g. This region, is known to consist of miles of green hills and thick forests.
- dotted** (adjective): placed here and there
e.g. It is reported to be dotted with picturesque villages and cities.
- fiercely** (adverb): passionately
e.g. The Basques are fiercely proud.





Learning Points

Passive Infinitives for Speculation

You use passive infinitives in writing when you want to demonstrate that something is believed or is thought to happen. This type of writing is common in articles and texts about historical events.

Look at the following example:

*Euskal Herria **is believed to be** home to more than 3 million Basque people.*

The writer wants to communicate the fact that they suppose or speculate that the population of the area is 3 million.

Common verbs used in these types of constructions are:

*believe
think
report
expect
allege
consider
know
rumor
say*

Take a look at some other examples of these kinds of sentences in the text:

Examples:

- *Euskal Herria is believed to be home to more than 3 million Basque people. It is said to translate as "land of the Basque language."*
- *This region, is known to consist of miles of green hills and thick forests.*
- *It is reported to be dotted with picturesque villages and cities.*
- *While about half of the Basque people are said to still dwell in villages.*
- *It's seen in their language, which is considered to be the tie that binds all Basques.*
- *As an old Basque was said to proclaim ...*





Learning Points

Gerunds After Prepositions

When you use a verb after a preposition, you must use a gerund (*verb+ -ing*).

You cannot use an infinitive after a preposition.

Some common prepositions are:

*before: Take your time **before** answering your questions.*

*for: They received extra homework **for** not listening in class.*

*after: He returned home **after** being in France for 3 years.*

*in: I'm not interested **in** history.*

*on: There's no point **on** talking about this anymore.*

*at: She is good **at** writing stories.*

Usually, we use the preposition "to" before a verb in order to show that it is in infinitive.

For example:

I want to practice the lesson with you.

Examples:

- *The early Basques decided on settling the area thousands of years ago.*
- *Through the centuries, they got used to facing Roman, Arab, and French conquerors.*
- *They have always survived and kept on holding out as a separate cultural group.*
- *Many have become more interested in doing more lucrative industrial jobs.*
- *Many others have decided on joining the fast growing high-tech sector.*
- *The Festival of San Fermin, is known for having the running of the bulls through the streets of Pamplona.*
- *God and boulders were boulders, the Basques were already devoted to being Basques.*

